dvca _travelers guide _for fine tuning your spacecraft

2 vcas	4 hp	10×+ gain on the curve side

› then noon = 12 o'clock tags = the panel drawing

two voltage-controlled amplifiers in 4 hp · after mutable instruments veils · volume knob, envelope vca, mixer

01 what it is

dv_01

two vcas	two identical voltage-controlled amplifiers in 4 hp · after the original mutable instruments veils
a vca	a volume knob that a voltage can turn · no voltage, no knob: silence
dc-coupled	passes audio or cv, so it scales modulation too
mixer	with nothing in **out 1**, **out 2** carries both channels

02 as a volume knob

dv_02 · the safe setup · fig.01

patch	sound into **in 1** (middle row) · **out 1** (bottom row) to the mixer
leave	**cv 1** (top row) empty · it then sits at a steady +8 V, so the knob alone opens the vca
c1 **[curve]**	all the way to the straight-line icon · even, predictable volume
1 **[gain 1]**	now the volume · fully left = silent
unity	about 1 o'clock = the level that went in · further right adds up to ~1.6×
distortion?	curve turned toward the curved icon · the top of the knob then goes past 10× and clips · back to the line

__fig.10 : the gain knob

as a volume knob



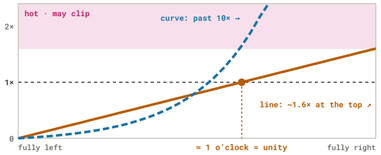
10 first flight

dv_10 · ten seconds to sound

1. sound into **in 1** (middle row)
2. **out 1** (bottom row) to your mixer
3. nothing in **cv 1** (top row)
4. **c1** **[curve]** to the straight line
5. raise **1** **[gain 1]** · about 1 o'clock = unity
6. then try an envelope into **cv 1** for a pluck

__fig.01 : the safe zone

gain knob · cv empty



shape, not measured · veils: empty cv = +8 V, +5 V at full gain = 1×

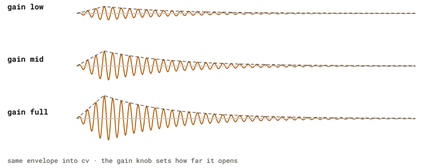
03 what the knobs do

dv_03 · big + small

1 **[gain]** **2**	nothing in cv: a plain volume knob
cv patched	it becomes the cv amount · how far the cv can open the vca · this is the attenuator
c1 **[curve]** **c2**	not an attenuator · it bends the response, line to curve
› **[line]**	linear · even steps · volume, mixing, scaling cv
› **[curve]**	exponential · snappy, natural fades from envelopes · lots of gain at the top

__fig.05 : cv × gain

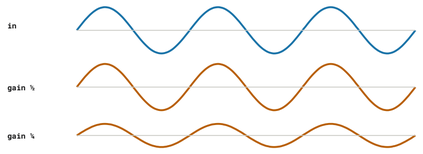
gain = cv amount



same envelope into cv · the gain knob sets how far it opens

__fig.07 : attenuator

scaling cv



curve on line · cv empty · same shape, smaller · dc-coupled so slow cv works too

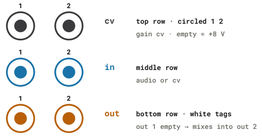
04 the jacks

dv_04 · three rows per channel

cv 1 **cv 2**	top row (circled 1 · 2) · gain cv · +5 V with the knob full = unity · above +5 V may distort
› empty	held at +8 V, so the knob alone sets the gain
in 1 **in 2**	middle row (labelled in 1 · in 2) · audio or cv
out 1 **out 2**	bottom row (white 1 · 2 tags)
how we know	oscillator in the top row: silence · in the middle row: sound

__fig.06 : which jack

top · middle · bottom



test: an oscillator in the top row = silence · in the middle row = sound

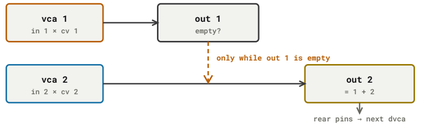
05 mixing

dv_05 · fig.02

out 1 empty	channel 1 joins channel 2 · **out 2** = 1 + 2
out 1 patched	two separate vcas
more dvcas	rear IN / OUT pins chain modules into one bigger mixer · a jumper for neighbours, a female-female dupont cable for spaced ones

__fig.02 : the output chain

out 1 empty = mixer



07 the lights

dv_07 · one per channel

brightness	signal level at the output
colour	polarity · green = positive (veils)
too bright?	a jumper on the back turns them off

__fig.09 : the lights

one per channel



08 five patches

dv_08 · curve · cv

volume knob — line · no cv
section 02 · gain 1 around 1 o'clock = unity

pluck / envelope vca — curve · env
osc into in · envelope into cv · gain = how far the envelope opens it · curve side for snappier decays

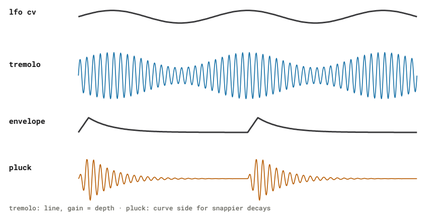
tremolo — line · lfo
lfo into cv · gain sets the depth · lower the gain if the peaks crunch

two-into-one mixer — line · no cv
sources into in 1 + in 2 · out 1 empty · out 2 = the mix · gains = levels

cv attenuator — line · no cv
lfo or envelope into in · gain scales it · out = smaller copy, same shape

__fig.08 : tremolo · pluck

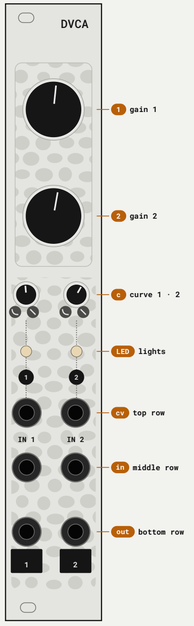
cv in, sound out



tremolo: line, gain = depth · pluck: curve side for snappier decays

__fig.03 : the panel

numbers match the legend



1 **gain 1**	volume · cv amount when patched
2 **gain 2**	same for channel 2
c **curve**	straight line = even · curve = hot
LED **lights**	output level · polarity
cv **cv 1 / 2**	top row · +8 V when empty
in **in 1 / 2**	middle row · audio or cv
out **out 1 / 2**	bottom row · 1 empty → 2 mix…

09 specs

dv_09

cv in	0 – 5 V for the full range · empty = +8 V
signal in	dc-coupled · audio or cv
size	4 hp · 22 mm deep
power	17 mA +12 V · 17 mA −12 V
design	mutable instruments veils by émilie gillet · cc-by-sa